

10

Migration

This chapter covers

- The internals of migration scripts
- Writing custom migrations, including manipulating existing data
- Combining and optimizing migration files
- Dealing with merge conflicts caused by changing a model

Django `Model` objects are proxies to tables in a database, and the migration system helps you maintain the relationship between the two. The migration system is a powerful tool that allows you to move forward and backward through state changes and manipulate data while doing so.

10.1 *Migration scripts in detail*

In chapter 4, you learned about Django’s ORM and how `Model` classes act as a proxy to tables in the database. You used the `makemigrations` and `migrate` commands to push changes down to the database that correspond to the code in your model